

MOHSIN ANWAR SHARIF

Endpoint Security & Security Operations Specialist | Microsoft Defender · SentinelOne · Zscaler | CISM · CIPP/E

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Nationality: Pakistani | Saudi work visa held, transferable with current sponsor's consent | Relocating to Riyadh | Available immediately

PROFILE

Endpoint and security operations specialist with six years inside one multi-country bank as it moved from Ahli United Bank to Kuwait Finance House. Administered SentinelOne, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint, Intune, Zscaler and ManageEngine across an estate that grew from ~8,000 endpoints to ~18,000 assets in Bahrain, Kuwait, UAE, Egypt, Libya, Iraq and the UK. Led the Defender proof of concept and acted as the bank's technical lead through phased rollout and SentinelOne decommissioning. Focused on proving that controls actually work, not just that agents are installed: component-level health checks, reconciled control reporting presented to the CISO, and post-implementation assessment frameworks with evidence and sign-off for Defender, SentinelOne, Darktrace and Zscaler. 15+ years in IT, security and operations.

CORE SKILLS

Endpoint & EDR: Microsoft Defender for Endpoint/Servers, SentinelOne Singularity (on-prem and cloud), Microsoft Intune, Entra ID, ManageEngine Endpoint Central, Microsoft Secure Score, Trend Micro Apex One (operations)

Network & web security: Zscaler ZIA (URL/application policy, SSL inspection, blocklists), Blue Coat, Forescout NAC, Darktrace NDR

Vulnerability & asset: Qualys VMDR and Policy Compliance (analysis; 7 Qualys specialist certifications), SentinelOne Ranger, Lansweeper, AWS instance onboarding

Operations & governance: Alert triage and containment, IOC/hash blocking, CAB/change, release and rollback, post-implementation assessment, DR exercises, KPI/KRI reporting, ISO/IEC 27001, PCI DSS 4.0, CBB

Other tools: KnowBe4 PhishER, CTM360, Nexthink, Netwrix, BigID, ArcSight (L1), Fortinet, Check Point, Palo Alto, F5

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Ahli United Bank → Kuwait Finance House, Bahrain

Sep 2019 – Oct 2025

Information Security & Endpoint Security Specialist, KFH, via Gulf Business Machines (Apr 2024 – Oct 2025) | IT Endpoint Security Specialist, AUB, via First Defense W.L.L. (Sep 2019 – Mar 2024). Same bank throughout; AUB was acquired by KFH.

- **Scope and progression:** Joined as SentinelOne administrator on a largely default-configured deployment and built custom policies, blocklists and exclusion governance; responsibilities expanded to ManageEngine, Zscaler, Intune and Defender. Estate grew from ~8,000 endpoints (on-prem) to ~15,000 agents after cloud migration and ~18,000 assets including servers after KFH integration.
- **SentinelOne administration:** Primary administrator across two on-prem and seven cloud consoles: ~20 policies, ~40 profiles, exclusions (ticketed, risk-approved, time-limited) and IOC/hash blocklist (~60,000 at peak). Tested each release (~every 35–40 days) on test laptops, VMs and cloned production servers with threat and CPU-load tests; deployed to production servers only in planned outage windows.
- **Defender migration:** Led the Microsoft Defender for Endpoint PoC against SentinelOne and was the bank's technical lead with the vendor through rollout and SentinelOne and Trend Micro decommissioning. Bahrain HQ went first (IT users, then departments, then test/UAT, database and production servers) before other entities. Each device was cut over by confirming Defender registered, removing the old agents, rebooting and verifying activation, with isolation if it failed; a wave closed only when every agent was online and alerts reached the SIEM. Migrated the SentinelOne IOC/hash blocklist into Defender indicators.
- **Self-service onboarding:** Built a Defender onboarding package on a shared folder that logged who ran it, when and with what local rights, so IT and server support could onboard machines without raising a ticket for the script.
- **Post-implementation assessments:** Authored assessment frameworks for Microsoft Defender (MDE, MDI and MDO with Intune), SentinelOne, Darktrace and Zscaler: a terms-of-reference scope (Defender mapped to NIST CSF, CIS and ISO 27001) and an Excel validation checklist recording each check, owner, evidence screenshot, pass/fail status and manager sign-off.
- **Control health assurance:** Ran component-level health checks through SentinelOne console remote scripting on online agents, and on manager-approved local-admin test machines for offline hosts. Built a standard offline-agent runbook (DNS, port 443, services, site binding, event logs, log collection) used before vendor escalation; fixed issues within platform authority or handed local-admin work to infrastructure, then retested.
- **Coverage gaps closed:** Used Trend Micro records to find 478 devices without functioning SentinelOne, triaged each (repair or reinstall) and reinstalled 180 active user machines; manually renewed an expired console certificate to reconnect ~450 agents in Egypt, then set expiry reminders on team mailboxes stating the impact (no recurrence); fixed ~500 ManageEngine agent failures from a Citrix golden image by requiring Citrix admin approval for agent assignment and a shared folder for image updates.
- **Incident response:** During a spear-phishing incident, used SentinelOne Deep Visibility to trace an AMSI-based attempt to disable Trend Micro and quarantined the endpoint; on my report, related agents were quarantined and deep-scanned before clearance. Supported DR drills and crisis war rooms.

- **SentinelOne cloud migration:** Drove the bank's first move of a security product to the cloud: gathered vendor answers on data retention, metadata and deletion, documented the case for Central Bank of Bahrain sign-off and presented benefits against risks to CAB and the risk committee. Kuwait and Egypt stayed on-prem under local rules.
- **Zscaler:** Security operations technical lead for the Blue Coat to Zscaler ZIA transition, then administered ZIA policies, SSL inspection bypasses and blocklists. Resolved breakages in trading feeds, transaction log transfers and in-house applications through approved bypasses; onboarded ~800 users as default proxy (Q1 2024).
- **Reporting to leadership:** Built a workbook joining ten tools against the asset inventory to show which controls covered each device, and kept a daily per-tool coverage tracker through migration waves; authored the biweekly control-status pack for the CISO and later presented it, defending figures wave by wave. Adapted SentinelOne's Power Query API template to pull agent data straight into Excel.
- **Darktrace and BigID:** Security operations lead for both rollouts (2024–2025). Darktrace: worked with the network team and vendor, and tuned early false positives (e.g. Qualys scans flagged as lateral movement) by labelling alerts. BigID: reported progress to management, unblocked access with application owners and the network team, monitored vendor activity, and coordinated DSAR erasure requests flagged in BigID through to verified closure.
- **Microsoft endpoint management:** Created and assigned Intune configuration profiles and, with several admins on the tenant, reviewed policies others created for conflicts before release; ran 30-60-90-day follow-up on low Secure Score devices with the Qualys and patching teams.
- **Vulnerability, asset and access:** Compared Qualys, Defender and SentinelOne Ranger findings, using ManageEngine to confirm active assets; reconciled Lansweeper discoveries against console records to separate true coverage gaps from false positives; compared Forescout NAC agent coverage against ManageEngine and Defender with the contracted NAC team; onboarded ~105 AWS instances. Supported six-monthly AD reviews and flagged ~235 dormant VDI's consuming security licences for disablement.
- **GRC and audit support:** Technical contact for auditors on endpoint, proxy and identity controls during ISO 27001, PCI DSS and CBB assessments: supplied evidence and explained risk-based decisions, such as why production servers were not set to automatic block. Tested controls and cleared false positives for the minimum security baseline project.

IT Security & Infrastructure Specialist — Transworld Information Systems

Feb 2018 – Aug 2019

- Supported servers, networks, storage, patching and endpoint protection; implemented firewall, antivirus and access-control changes.
- Reviewed Qualys vulnerability and policy-compliance reports, validated findings against assigned assets and escalated patching and configuration gaps.

Executive Sales & Operations Manager — SGE Enterprise, Bahrain

Dec 2014 – Jan 2018

- Supervised a 15-person team: work allocation, quality checks, escalations and SLA delivery for corporate and government clients.

System Analyst, Network Operations Centre — Zain Telecommunications (via ITS)

Jan 2008 – Sep 2014

- One of an 8-person shift team in the 24/7 monitoring centre: monitored telco node utilisation and network congestion and reported issues to telecom engineers; managed backup jobs and cartridges; ran billing cycles through bulk printing, quality checks and courier handover. Trained on SMARTS and eHealth network monitoring (Intracom Telecom, 2008).

CERTIFICATIONS

- CISM — Certified Information Security Manager, ISACA (2026)
- CIPP/E — Certified Information Privacy Professional/Europe, IAPP (2026)
- Qualys Certified Specialist (7): VMDR, Endpoint Detection and Response, PCI Compliance, Enterprise TruRisk Management, CyberSecurity Asset Management, Cloud Agent, TotalCloud (2026)
- ISO/IEC 27001:2022 Lead Auditor — Mastermind Assurance (2025)
- GRCP — Certified GRC Professional; IAIP — Certified Integrated AI Professional, OCEG (2026)

Training: AI security and governance: Securiti AI Security & Governance; Anthropic AI Fluency, Claude 101, Claude Platform 101. BigID platform series (Fundamentals, Core 1–4, Classifiers, Retention, Remediation & Deletion).

EDUCATION & LANGUAGES

B.Sc. (Science), University of the Punjab, Lahore, Pakistan, 2007

English (professional), Urdu/Hindi (native), Arabic (basic)